

Name: Kenn Arcenal**Date: July 21, 2026****Section: E-EDUC1****Score: _____****Reflecting on the Different Educational Periods***Instructions:*

1. *Select educational periods you find meaningful in terms of their contribution and practice.*
2. *Answer Column 2 by identifying significant contributions brought about by the chosen educational periods.*
3. *Relate Column 3 with the present times. Practices may include but not limited to what is seen and observed in the classroom.*

Educational Period	Educational Contribution	Educational Practice
1. Education During the 21st Century	RA 9155 (2001) transformed DECS into DepEd and provided the framework for school-based management and school head empowerment. The K to 12 Program (RA 10533) made kindergarten compulsory and added Grades 11 and 12. This era also strengthened access and inclusion through laws such as the Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act (RA 10931, 2017), which provided free tuition in state universities and colleges, and the expansion of the Alternative Learning System for out-of-school youth and adults. Every graduate is formed in the core values of Maka-Diyos, Maka-tao, Makabansa, and Maka-Kalikasan, producing learners who are holistically developed and equipped with 21 st -century skills.	Classrooms today follow the learner-centered K to 12 curriculum, with kindergarten as the entry point and Senior High School tracks in academic, technical-vocational, sports, and arts strands that prepare students for college, employment, entrepreneurship, or middle-level skills development. School heads now manage their schools with greater autonomy through school-based management, guided by transparency and local accountability, while parents and communities participate through School Governing Councils and programs like Brigada Eskwela. The core values are integrated into daily lessons, flag ceremonies, and school activities, and inclusive practices continue to widen opportunities for learners of all backgrounds. This period also saw the rise of digital and blended learning, especially during the pandemic, reflecting the system's push toward flexible and future-ready education.
2. Education During the New Society (1972-1986)	Education was directed toward national development and made relevant to the needs of a changing world. The system was reorganized into the Ministry of	Bilingual teaching is still observed in classrooms today, since English is used in Science and Mathematics while Filipino is used in other

	Education and Culture with thirteen regional offices, and the Bilingual Education Policy introduced English and Filipino as media of instruction in specific learning areas. This period also produced lasting legal foundations for Philippine education, most notably the Education Act of 1982 (Batas Pambansa Blg. 232), which established an integrated system of education and defined the rights and duties of students, teachers, parents, and schools.	subjects. DepEd also continues to operate through the regional and division offices that trace back to this reorganization. The Education Act of 1982 remains in force today and continues to guide the rights and responsibilities of members of the educational community in both public and private schools. Its provisions on school governance and stakeholder roles are still reflected in current DepEd policies and everyday school operations.
3. Education During the American Period	A free, formal, and highly centralized public school system was established through Act No. 74 of 1901. The Thomasites came to teach, English became the medium of instruction, and the University of the Philippines (1908), high schools, and trade and agricultural schools were founded to teach democracy as a way of life.	Free public elementary and secondary education remains the backbone of Philippine schooling. English is still a medium of instruction, and classroom methods like socialized recitation, reporting, and active student participation, along with subjects such as values education, civics, and hygiene, all trace back to this period.
4. Education During the Republic (1943-1972)	Education pursued the full realization of democratic ideals and the promotion of equal educational opportunities for all. It emphasized the conservation of Filipino heritage, training for occupation, democratic nation building, and a new thrust on community development. The Department of Education was also created through E.O. No. 94 in 1947.	Equal access to education is now practiced through free basic education for every Filipino child. Filipino heritage is preserved in Filipino and Araling Panlipunan classes, while vocational training and community involvement, such as Brigada Eskwela, continue its thrust on occupation and community development.

Insights on the relevance of the identified contributions in achieving quality education

No educational period is perfect, and each one carried contradictions that are worth examining honestly. The American system opened the doors of free public schooling to ordinary Filipinos, yet it was also an instrument of colonial control that imposed a foreign language and quietly displaced local ways of knowing. The Republic proclaimed equal opportunity and a return to Filipino identity, but access to education remained uneven across social classes and far-flung regions, so the promise was often greater than the reality. The New Society advanced national development and strengthened the organization of the system, however, the power struggles of those times often overshadowed and overpowered the administration's original objectives and the broader development of that era. Even the reforms of the 21st century, for all their ambition, continue to wrestle with poverty, overcrowding, teacher shortages, and stubborn gaps in the quality of learning. Seen critically, then, the history of Philippine education is not a straight line of progress but a series of hard-won advances, each shadowed by its own limitations.

Yet this is precisely what makes these four periods so significant. They are perhaps the most relevant, the most widely felt in classrooms today, and the most enduring in shaping the system we now have. The American period laid the foundation of a free and formal public school system that still serves millions. The Republic widened access and rooted learning in Filipino heritage and values. The New Society aligned education with national development and left behind lasting legal foundations, most notably the Education Act of 1982, that continue to govern schools today. And the 21st century united these gains through learner-centered governance and the K to 12 reform, extending basic education and placing the child at the center of the process. Each era, in other words, corrected something the previous one lacked, and together they reveal that quality education is built layer by layer rather than achieved all at once.

Taken as a whole, these contributions show that genuine quality in education rests on four pillars working together, which are accessible schools, a relevant and responsive curriculum, strong values formation, and leadership that is accountable to the people it serves. When these elements move in harmony, and when their weaknesses are confronted honestly rather than ignored or excused, education becomes more than the transfer of knowledge. It becomes the deliberate formation of caring, self-reliant, productive, and patriotic citizens who are capable of improving their own lives and lifting the nation along with them. That, ultimately, is the enduring lesson these periods offer to the present, that progress in education is never finished, but is instead a responsibility each generation must take up and carry forward.

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Use of AI Statement

Grammarly was used solely for language refinement, and ChatGPT only for the initial search of relevant documents. The conceptualization, writing, and selection of relevant educational periods were personally done by the author, who takes full responsibility for this work.